

Razer Starcraft II

Razer has unveiled a new line of gaming mice custom designed for Starcraft II

Intel SSDs

Intel's new line of SSDs (codenamed Elm Crest) would be available in 120 and 250 GB variants

DIY

The complications

Based on feedback from you, we realised that not all of you are comfortable with multimeters and soldering irons, or even



Set your phone to Silent mode

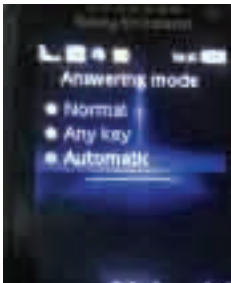
too happy to rip devices apart. Thus we've decided to go about this DIY in a much simpler manner than most are used to. More advanced ways of using old phones will follow

in subsequent issues.

Setting up the phone

In order to use a phone as a surveillance device, as we said before, all you really have to do is change a few settings. More effort will go into concealing the fact that there's a phone lying about.

Let's take a quick look at the phone settings: the functional phone we found ourselves with was a Sony Ericsson K850i. The setting names might differ between



Finally, set the Answering mode to Automatic

brands, but you shouldn't have any trouble getting the gist of it.

First go to Phone Settings, and look for profiles and set the phone to silent mode, with no vibrations or audio/visual indica-

tors of any sort – turn off backlight, turn off blinking LEDs, or anything that screams "I'm a phone!". Some phones don't allow you to disable the audible low battery warnings, so it's best to check this before you plan your espionage.

Next, just look for your phone's Answering Mode. This is where you'll set your phone to answer calls automatically. Some phones will let you answer the calls immediately, or only after a few rings. Either way, since you're not going to be around to press the Accept button, this is the essential step in turning the



Make sure you disable Vibrating alert

device from a phone into a bug. Make sure to test the way the new monitoring device works, and of course remember to use a SIM card that you don't use and don't get too many calls on. The last thing you want is a telemarketer calling and spying on people using your phone.

The hard way

The more adventurous amongst you can get rid of all the flab in the cell phone by removing the cover and getting rid of the speaker. You could tape over the display also to prevent any light from leaking out, and also end up with a much smaller bug.

We also had an old Sony Ericsson T200 handy, which had been put through much abuse and didn't break



Black tape on the screen to hide the light



The speaker is the one on the top left

device from a phone into a bug.

Make sure to test the way the new monitoring device works, and of course remember to use a SIM card that you don't use and don't



Taping the battery in place

any hearts when we ripped it open. The pictures will tell you the story.

Camouflage

In order to hide your bug you're going to need some sort of container. Just remember to avoid placing it next to speakers or a CRT monitor, where it will be easily discovered. You're also going to need to charge it regularly, which may make it hard to fix it in place behind or inside another object. You can, of course, connect the charger and hide it in a place with a



The finished bug is about one third the thickness of the original phone body, and cannot make any sounds

permanent power supply, but please don't shock yourself when trying to deal with electrical mains. You've been warned!

The spy game

Just call your SIM's number when you want to listen in to what's happening around the phone. Remember, it's illegal to spy on other people and invade their privacy. You can earn yourself a serious jail term if caught spying on people. However, no one can stop you from using surveillance devices on property you own, so use it at home and you'll be on the right side of the law. 